

scripts/systemd-install.sh — User Guide

Last verified: 2026-08-12 (initial version — systemd --user wiring for lava-api-go) **Inheritance:** HelixConstitution §11.4.18 + Lava §6.U (No-sudo/su Mandate) + §6.T.2 (Resource Limits)

Overview

Installs the lava-api-go container service (start.sh / stop.sh) as a **systemd --user unit**, so it can be started/stopped via systemctl --user and — via loginctl enable-linger — survive to boot time without an active login session. Every step runs in the invoking user's own account scope. No sudo/su is used or required anywhere in this script, per §6.U.

loginctl enable-linger (no argument, targeting the calling user's own account) is a config-safe, non-destructive logind operation — it is not in the CLAUDE.md Forbidden Command List (which covers suspend/hibernate/poweroff/kill-user/kill-session/etc.), and the pre-push guard hook (scripts/hooks/guard-forbidden-commands.sh) only blocks that specific dangerous-subcommand set, not enable-linger.

Why oneshot + RemainAfterExit

start.sh brings up the lava-api-go container (via tools/lava-containers) and then exits — it is not itself a long-running foreground process. The rendered unit (systemd/user/lava-api.service.template) therefore uses Type=oneshot with RemainAfterExit=yes: systemctl --user considers the unit "active" once start.sh exits 0, and ExecStop=stop.sh tears the container back down on systemctl --user stop.

Usage

```
./scripts/systemd-install.sh          # render unit, daemon-  
                                     reload, enable (does not start)  
./scripts/systemd-install.sh --start  # same, then start  
                                     immediately
```

What it does, in order:

1. Renders systemd/user/lava-api.service.template to ~/.config/systemd/user/lava-api.service, substituting the repo's absolute path for `__LAVA_REPO_ROOT__`.
2. `systemctl --user daemon-reload`
3. `systemctl --user enable lava-api.service`
4. Checks `loginctl show-user <you> --property=Linger`; if not already yes, runs `loginctl enable-linger` (no sudo — operates on the caller's own account only).
5. With `--start`, also runs `systemctl --user start lava-api.service`.

Verifying it worked

```
./scripts/systemd-status.sh
```

Per CLAUDE.md §6.B ("container 'Up' is not application-healthy"), a green `systemctl --user status` only proves the unit ran `start.sh` to completion — it does NOT prove the API is actually serving traffic. `systemd-status.sh` additionally calls `tools/lava-containers/bin/lava-containers -cmd=status`, which reports the real container health (Healthy: true/false) and the live /health URL — that second line is the load-bearing signal.

Reversing

```
./scripts/systemd-uninstall.sh
```

Stops the unit if active, disables it, removes the rendered unit file, and reloads the systemd `--user daemon`. Does not touch `linger` (an account-wide setting other `--user` units may depend on) — disable it separately with `loginctl disable-linger` if desired.

Falsifiability note

This is infrastructure glue, not a testable code path in the Anti-Bluff Pact sense (no production Kotlin/Go logic to mutate). Its correctness is verified operationally: `systemctl --user status` reports active (exited) with `RemainAfterExit`, and `lava-containers -cmd=status` reports Healthy: true after `--start`.